

ACTIVITY 8 — FACILITATOR GUIDE

Customer Perspective Analysis

TYPE	DURATION	MAPS TO	TOPIC
Role Play	25 minutes	LU2	LU2 — Customer Influence

Purpose of this activity

By the end of this activity learners will be able to perform active listening from the customer to understand the customer's perspective of the organisation (LU2).

What learners produce

A customer-perspective analysis: the emotion behind Priya's words, a coaching note against the 3 P's, and one actionable insight for the relaunch team.

Materials required

- Learner Worksheet (one per learner)
- Checklist (one per group)
- Flipchart or A3 sheet and markers
- The course slides for the scenario and framework
- Internet access where the activity calls for live research

Set-up

Groups of exactly 3 so every role is played. Distribute one worksheet per learner and one checklist per group. All 17 activities run on the same continuous Nimbus Wellness scenario, so remind learners of where this activity sits in that story before you start.

Scenario / briefing material

Priya has bought from Nimbus Wellness since its first year. Last night she read the same community Facebook thread the Activity 4 audit flagged — customers saying Nimbus "doesn't feel personal anymore" — and she agrees. This morning she calls Customer Service, frustrated, wanting to know why the brand she used to feel loyal to now treats her like any other order number.

The rep taking the call has a real average-handle-time target and a bank of quick-reply macros that would close this call in under two minutes. But leadership has asked every Customer Service call this week to be an active-listening opportunity, not just a resolution — because this exact situation is what the relaunch's active-listening approach will need to prove it can handle.

Your group of three will run this call as a role play, coached in real time against the 3 P's, then turn what was actually said — not just what was resolved — into a documented customer-perspective insight for the relaunch team.

Roles

Assign one role per participant:

- **The Customer (Priya)** — *Goal: Be heard and taken seriously, not just processed.* A five-year loyal customer who feels increasingly like a transaction. She isn't asking for a refund — she wants to know if anyone at Nimbus still cares.
- **Nimbus Service Rep** — *Goal: Resolve the call by genuinely listening, not by closing it fast.* Under real pressure to keep the call short, but has been told this week that how the call feels matters as much as how quickly it ends.
- **Observer / Coach** — *Goal: Apply the 3 P's framework as a coaching lens on the call.* Says nothing during the role play itself, but tracks exactly where Presence, Patience and Paraphrasing show up — or don't — to coach the Rep afterwards.

How to run it — step by step

#	Instruction to learners	Facilitator note
1	Assign the three roles. Customer (Priya), Nimbus Service Rep, Observer/Coach. Groups of three exactly. If your table has more, run two parallel trios rather than adding spectators.	Reps almost always start solving before Priya finishes. Let it happen — it is the most teachable moment the Observer will capture.
2	Brief the Observer before the call starts. The Observer prepares a three-column note — Presence, Patience, Paraphrasing — and says NOTHING during the role play. Their only job is to record the moment and the exact words where each P appeared or was missed.	If Priya states 'I want to know if anyone cares' outright, the exercise loses its point. Re-brief and restart if needed.
3	Brief Priya privately. Priya is not asking for a refund. She wants to know whether anyone at Nimbus still cares. She should not state this directly — she should express it as frustration about small things, the way real customers do. That gap is what the Rep must hear.	Rotate roles if time allows; playing Priya changes how people take calls afterwards.
4	Brief the Rep on the real tension. The Rep has an average-handle-time target and macros that would close this in under two minutes. They must feel that pressure genuinely — the learning comes from choosing listening over speed while the pressure is real.	
5	Run the call. Play it live for the full time. Do not stop to correct — the Observer's notes depend on the call running uninterrupted, including its mistakes.	
6	Coach against the three P's. The Observer walks through their notes: Presence (was the Rep fully attending or queuing a macro?), Patience (did they let silences sit, or fill them?), Paraphrasing (did they reflect Priya's meaning back	

	without judgement?). Cite specific moments and words, never general impressions.	
7	Name the emotion behind the words. Separate the literal complaint from the emotion driving it. The words are about service speed and templates; the emotion is usually feeling forgotten by a brand she helped build. Write the emotion in one honest sentence.	
8	Paraphrase Priya's perspective in one sentence. Draft the single sentence the Rep could have said that would have made Priya feel heard — without judgement and without minimising. Test it on the person who played Priya: would it have landed?	
9	Write the actionable insight. Convert the call into one insight the relaunch team can act on. 'The customer was upset' is an observation, not an insight. 'Long-tenure customers read macro replies as evidence the brand has outgrown them' is actionable.	

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
4 min	Assign roles and brief the Observer on the 3 P's
8 min	Run the call as a live role play
5 min	Observer coaches against Presence, Patience, Paraphrasing
5 min	Name the emotion behind the words
3 min	Write the actionable insight for the relaunch team

Total: 25 minutes

Discussion & decision prompts

1. As the call plays out, where does the Rep genuinely apply Presence, Patience and Paraphrasing — and where do they slip back into passive hearing?
2. What emotion is actually behind Priya's words, as distinct from the literal complaint she's making?
3. How would the Observer paraphrase Priya's perspective back in one honest sentence, without judgement and without minimising it?
4. Beyond "the customer was upset," what concrete, actionable insight should this call generate for the relaunch team?

Debrief

Bring the class back together and draw out the learning:

- Ask two or three groups to show what they produced, not just what they concluded.
- Ask what surprised them — the gap between what they assumed and what they found.
- Link the activity explicitly back to LU2 — Customer Influence.
- Remind learners this activity rehearses what the Case Study assessment will require.

Reflection questions:

- As the Customer, at what point in the call did you feel genuinely heard — or feel yourself give up on being heard?
- As the Rep, was it harder to stay patient, or harder to paraphrase without sounding scripted?
- As the Observer, which of the 3 P's was missing most often, and what would you coach first?

Facilitator notes — what to watch for

- Reps almost always start solving before Priya finishes. Let it happen — it is the most teachable moment the Observer will capture.
- If Priya states 'I want to know if anyone cares' outright, the exercise loses its point. Re-brief and restart if needed.
- Rotate roles if time allows; playing Priya changes how people take calls afterwards.

Success criterion

Every group can show a completed customer-perspective analysis that names the emotion behind Priya's words (not just the words themselves), cites a specific moment where a P was applied or missed, and closes with one actionable insight for the relaunch team.

Assessment link

This activity builds LU2 — Customer Influence. All 17 activities are in-class activities assessed indirectly through the open-book Case Study (CS) component, which reuses the same techniques on the same continuous Nimbus Wellness scenario. Knowledge is assessed in the Written Assessment (WA-SAQ). Nothing is assessed that is not practised here or taught in the slides.